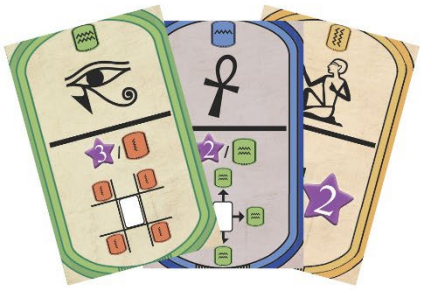
HIEROGLYPHS

- 1-4 Players
- Ages 13+
- 15-20mins / player

Objective of the Game

As an Egyptian scribe, you must position papyrus on your board and use the powers granted from the Gods to gain the most points.

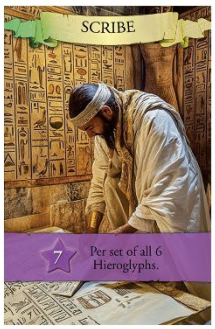
Contents



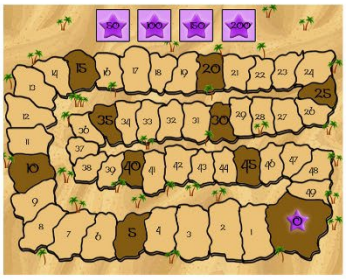
74 Papyrus Cards



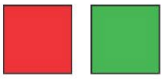
12 God Cards



4 Scribe Cards



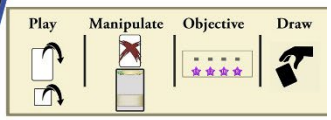
Scoreboard



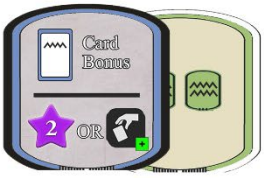
32 player markers (8 per player)



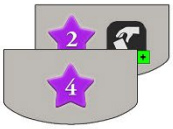
28 starter Papyrus cards



Phase Board



32 Remnants (8 per player)



12 Improvement Tokens



42 Hieroglyph Tokens



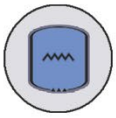
20 Scales



16 Oasis



10 Sun Tokens



16 Colour Tokens



8 Refresh Tokens



8 Card Draw Tokens



10 Aten cards



10 remnant Tokens



4 solo cards

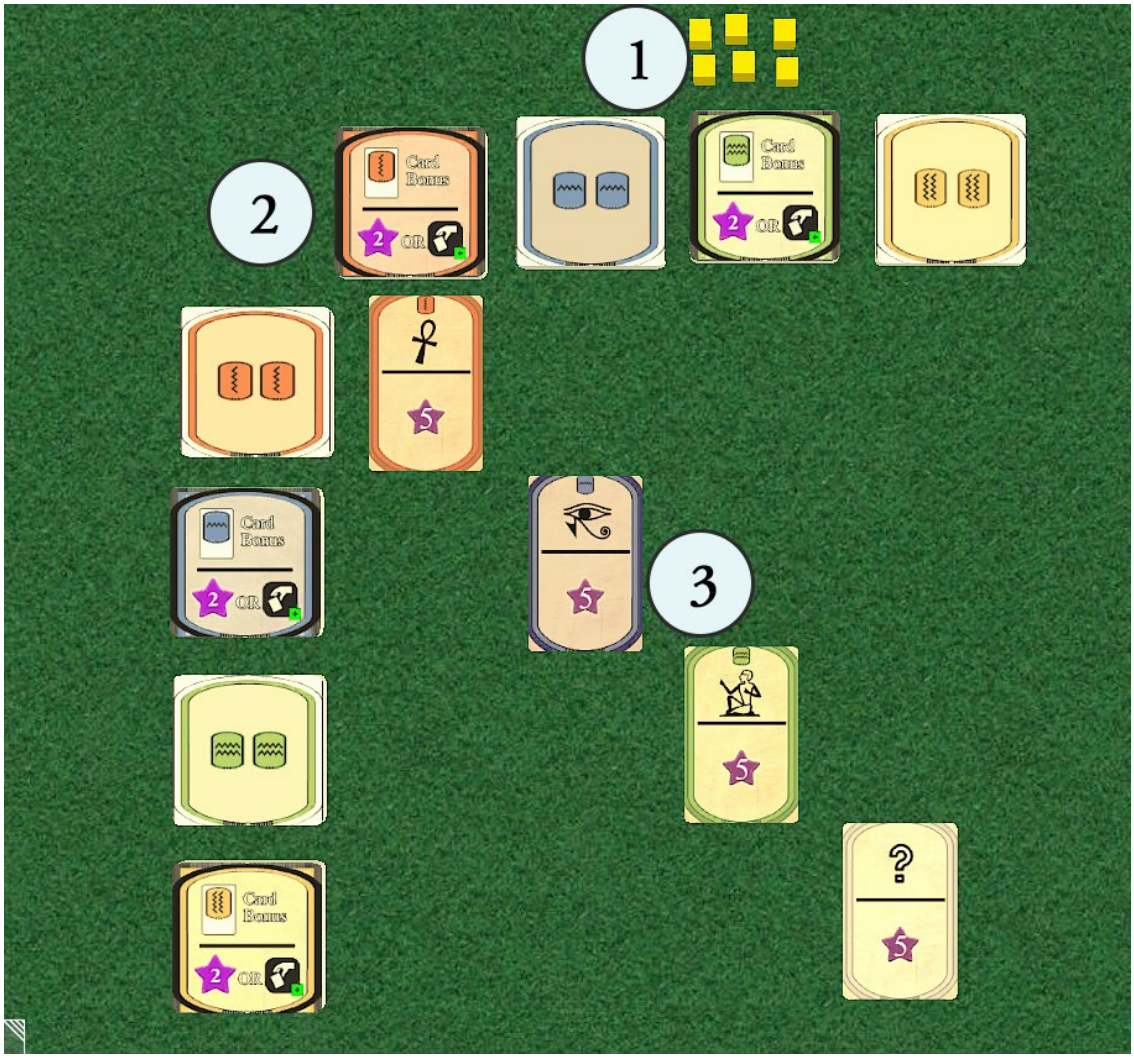


First Player Token

4 Player Aids

Setup

Player Set up



1. All players choose a colour and place all their markers in front of them in their supply.
2. Each player takes 8 remnants (2 in each colour).
    a. From left to right place 4 different coloured remnants in any order.
    b. From top to bottom, place remnants in a matching-coloured order to the top row.
    c. Make sure there is space for a 4x4 grid of papyrus cards.
    d. In the top row, have the black side of remnants in position 1 and 3 and white side 2 and 4.
    e. In the left column, have the black side of remnants in position 2 and 4 and white side 1 and 3.
3. Shuffle the Coloured starter papyrus cards. Each player randomly selects 3 of the coloured starter papyrus cards from the deck making sure they get 3 different colours and 3 different hieroglyphs. At the intersection of the matching-coloured remnants place the coloured starter cards. Place a “?” starter card in the last intersection.
    a. Shuffle the remaining starter cards into the deck.
4. Each player takes a player aid and randomly assigns a first player. Give them the First Player Token.

Communal Setup



5. Add all starter cards to the deck and then shuffle the Papyrus cards and place them face down in a stack to form a deck.

For a first game, take out all of these types of cards



   a. Each player takes 6 papyrus cards from the top of the deck to make their hand. These are hidden to other players.
   b. Deal out 4 papyrus cards to form the market face up.

6. Choose the Gods for the game. Randomly take one from each symbol type and place them face up. There should be on of each icon type present.

For a first game, it is recommended to only use 3 Gods. Use Bastet, Isis and Tawaret

7. Take Scribe cards and place them face up next to the God cards so that there are 6 total Scribe + Gods.

For a first game, it is recommended to play the Scribes with the 5-point side face up.

8. Choose to play either the A side or B side of the objective tiles. Place them near the Gods and Scribes.
   a. If playing with 2 players, set the objectives in 2 columns
   b. If playing with 3 players, set the objectives in 3 columns
   c. If playing with 4 players, you can set them up in any orientation.

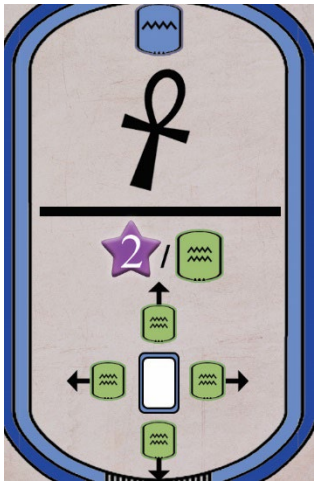
For a first game, it is recommended to use side A

9. Place the score track. Each player places a marker of their colour at 0 points.
10. Place the phase board and phase marker above the Play section.
11. Get all tokens out of the box that are needed for the respective Gods and place them near them based on the instructions in the God section.

For a first game, place the Refresh and Card draw tokens above Tawaret, Hieroglyph Tokens above Isis and Oasis Tokens above Bastet

Game Overview

Players will take turns playing a Papyrus card from their hand to their 4x4 grid (created by the remnants). Papyrus cards will have 2 purposes and the reasons why they may be placed in certain positions of the grid:



The top of the card has hieroglyphs. When cards are positioned in a specific order (left to right or top to bottom) that matches an objective, the player can claim it gaining points and other rewards.



The bottom of the card is an instantaneous ability that the player performs when the papyrus card is played into their grid. Most of these will give points based on existing elements of their grid.

Additionally, players can perform one of the available God abilities that can allow you to manipulate your grid for objectives and scoring opportunities.

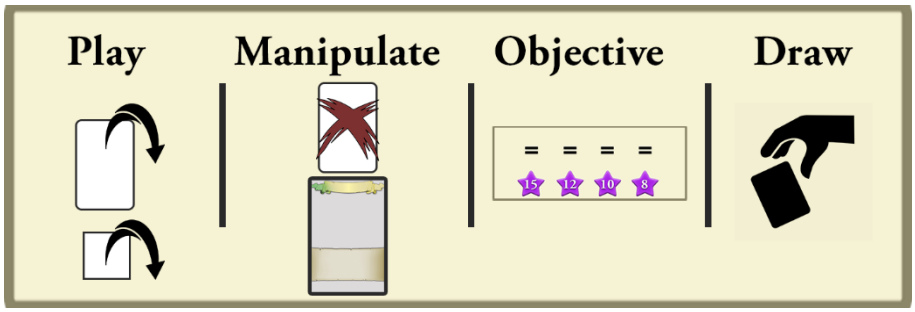


Players will play twelve rounds until their board is full of cards. Once the twelfth round is over, players calculate their points with the player with the most being the winner.

Round Structure

Each round will consist of 4 phases. Starting with the first player, a player will perform an action for the phase. It will then go to the next player clockwise to perform the same action until it comes back to the first player again. They will then move the phase marker to the next phase and repeat the process. (The player with the first player marker will be responsible for moving the marker).

Once the Draw phase is done, pass the first player marker to the next player clockwise. They will be the first player next round.

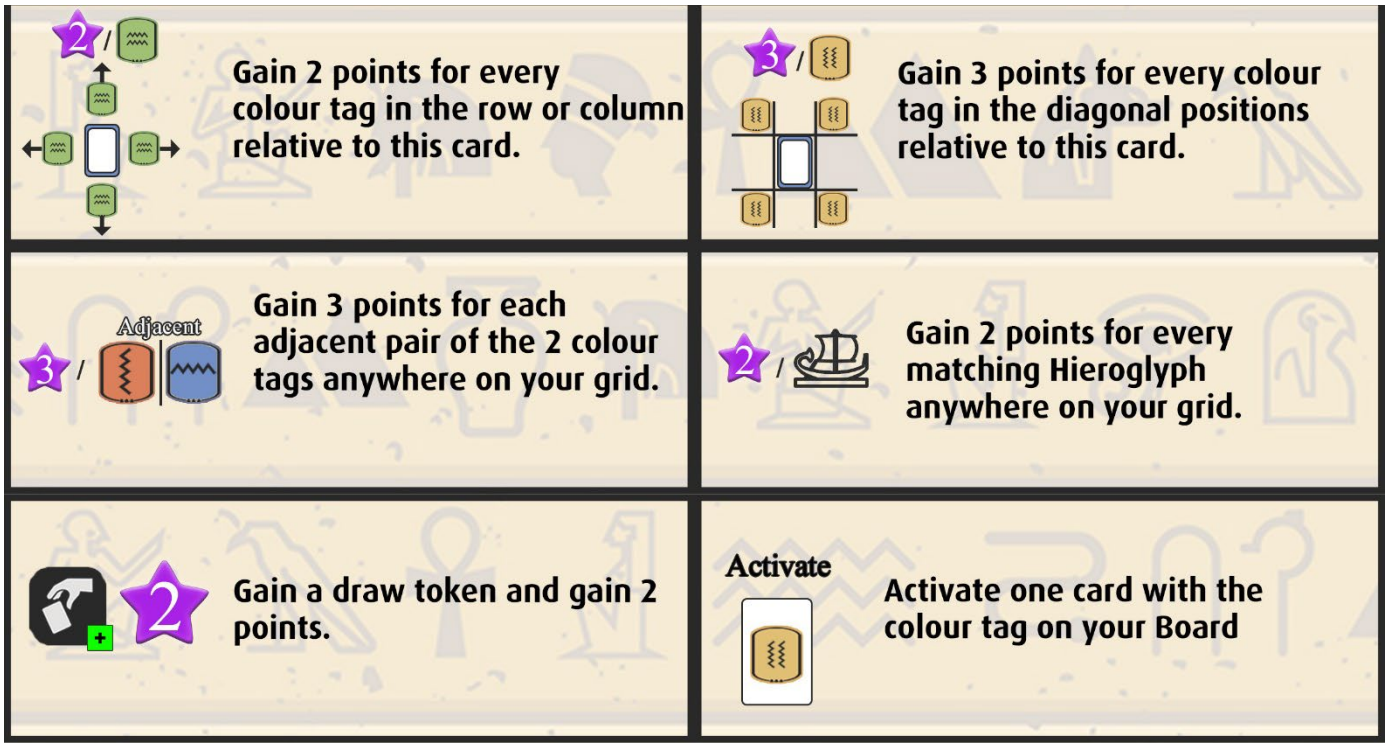


Play

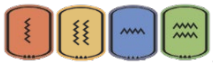
Players must play one papyrus card from their hand. They may also play as many tokens from their general supply that they want and are able to. The order in which they perform and resolve the following is up to the player.

Playing a card

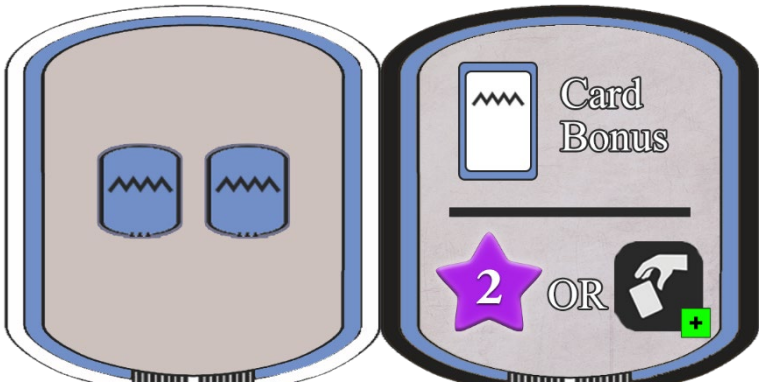
A player must play a card into one of the empty grid spaces. They resolve the following action at the bottom of the played card. These will usually give you points in various ways based on what is already on your board.



Remnants and colour tags

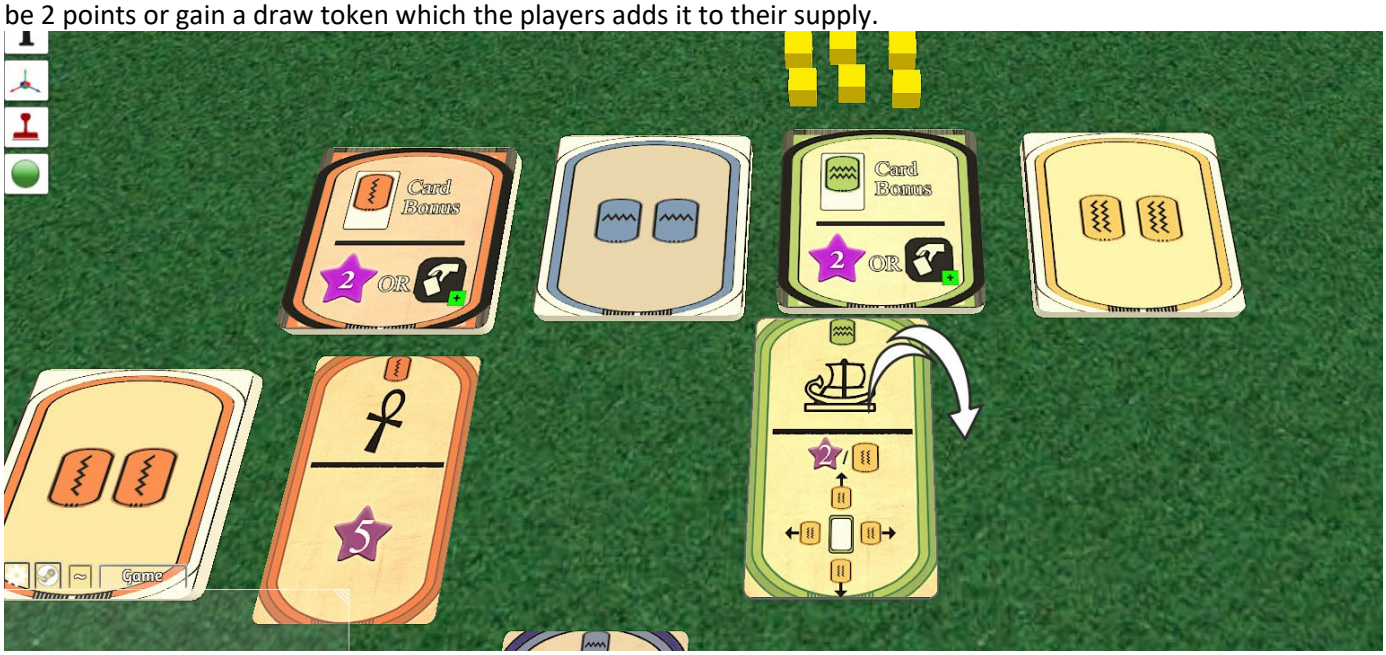
There are four colours tags  . These will generally be used to score you points in various ways from abilities.  is a wild tag that can be changed once per round and at game end for scoring purposes to any of the above 4 colours based on that players choice.

Around the side of the board are your remnants that will display these colour tags.



On the white side, a remnant will display 2 colour tags that can be used for scoring opportunities like any other card in your grid.

On the black side, there is a card bonus matching the outside remnant to the played card in the grid. This will either be 2 points or gain a draw token which the players adds it to their supply.



The player played the green card into the same column as the green remnant with the card bonus. They can now take 2 points or a draw token.

Playing Tokens from your Supply

If a player has gained a token from their supply in a previous turn (usually from a God ability) they may play the token(s) at any time. See the God section for a list of tokens and rules.

Any token with a  icon can only be played in the Draw phase.



Manipulate

Players can discard a card from their hand to perform any of the God abilities in the game. *(discard pile is next to the draw pile).*

Each God has a specialty that can assist you for future turns. There are always 3 or 4 God types that perform the core function differently.

 Gain Hieroglyph tokens that can change the top of cards played.

 Helps manipulate the market.

 Move cards around the board.

 Allow you to flip and move remnants.

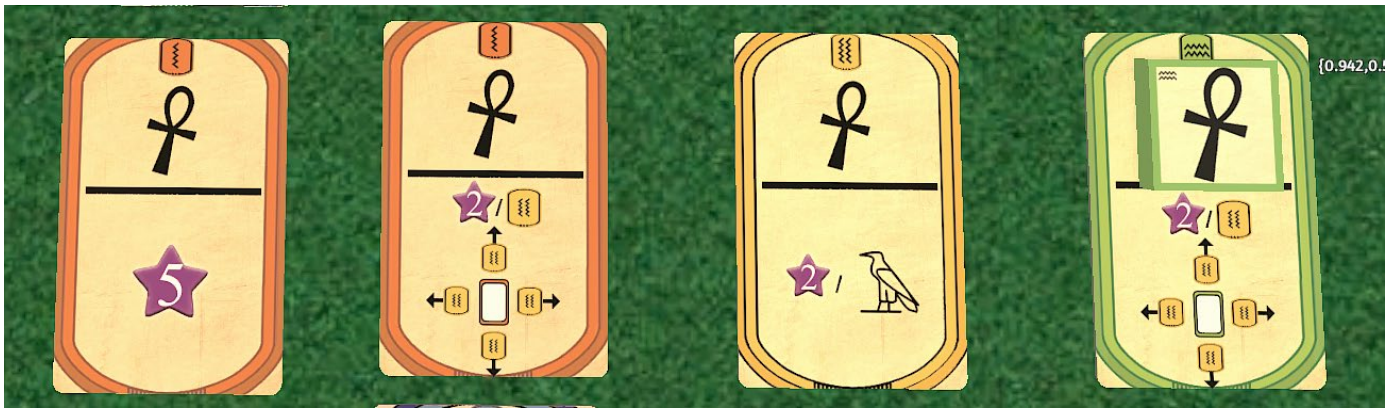
See list of Gods on page#

Objective

A player can complete an objective if they have cards in their grid with matching hieroglyphs to the objective played in order from left to right or top to bottom. These have to be in the exact order. If a player can't complete or doesn't want to complete an objective, they pass.

A player can only complete the same objective one.





Perform the following when a player completes an objective.

1. Move one of the players markers to the highest point value visible on the tile.
2. If this is the first player to claim this objective, that player gets to choose the additional benefit. Move the objective either under a God or a Scribe card.
    a. If placed under a God, that player gets to perform the Gods ability without having to discard a card.
    b. If placed under a Scribe, they will gain the additional points at the end of the game.

3. For 2 and 3 player games, place a dummy player marker that is not being used on the highest revealed point value of the other objective tiles in the same column.
4. If this is not the first time an objective is claimed by a player, the player places their marker on the next highest value and gains the same reward as step 2.

All points gained from objectives and scribes will be gained at game end.

Draw

Each player takes a turn drawing a card from the market. They may draw the top card of the deck blindly instead if they wish.

 Player may discard all cards in the market and then replace all cards.

 Player may draw an additional card.

Once the player has finished their turn, the market is filled up again with cards.

Game End

The game ends after the twelfth round when all players have a full grid. Players will calculate their points by the following.

1. All points accumulated through the game.
2. Players gain all points from objectives and Scribes in which they have claimed.
3. For every token still in their supply, that player gains 1 point.
4. For every card still in their hand, that player gains 1 point.
5. Players gain points from tokens with end game points (stars on them).

The player with the most points is the winner.

Gods and Tokens

Tokens are used to perform additional actions. In most circumstances when you gain a token, they get added to your supply (area around your grid) to be used in a future turn.

 Indicates you will gain the token to your supply.

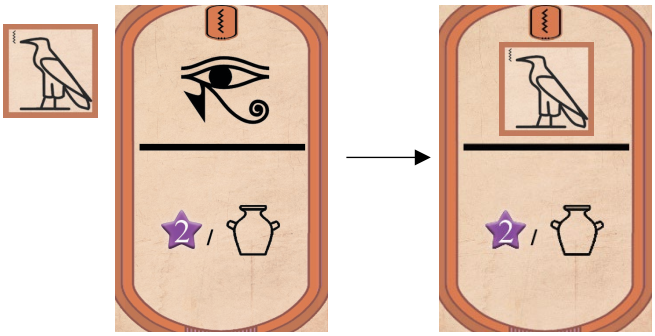
Gods

These Gods give players Hieroglyph Tokens which are used to replace the hieroglyphs on cards in their grid.

Hieroglyph Tokens



In the Play Phase, a player may place a Hieroglyph Token on any card in their Grid that matches the colour of the Hieroglyph token. If they place a hieroglyph token over another hieroglyph token, the replaced token is sent back to the middle for players to gain.



Isis



Gain 2 Hieroglyph Tokens that are different in colour and hieroglyph.

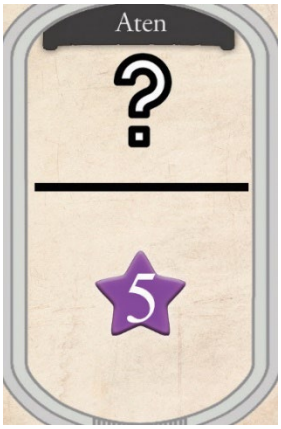
You may place a Hieroglyph Token on any card in your grid. This negates the colour matching rule.

Aten



Gain a Hieroglyph Token.

Gain an Aten Card to your Hand – If an Aten card is used to complete an objective, flip the Aten card over face down.



Aten cards are the same as the starter card. They count as all Hieroglyphs but have no colour tag. They add an additional card to your hand which can be used to discard for a God ability.

Gods

These Gods allow players to influence the market.

Draw Phase Tokens

These tokens can be played only in the draw phase. They help manipulate the market.

 Discard this token for the player to discard all cards in the market and then replace all cards.

 Discard this token for the player to draw an additional card.

Ra



Add a Sun token to each card in the Market without a sun token.

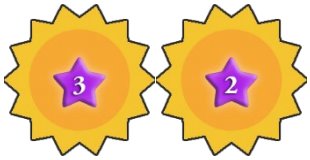
Draw a card.

Gain a Refresh Token.

When a player draws a card from the market they gain the additional reward of the Sun above the card. The Sun Token is then also discarded. Sun Tokens stay if the cards are refreshed.



Perform manipulation straight away



Gain points

Tawaret



Swap a card on you grid for a card in the market – you do not activate abilities. Any tokens on cards you swap stay on the card.

Draw a card.

Gain a Refresh Token.

These Gods allow players to move their cards around their board in various ways.

Bastet

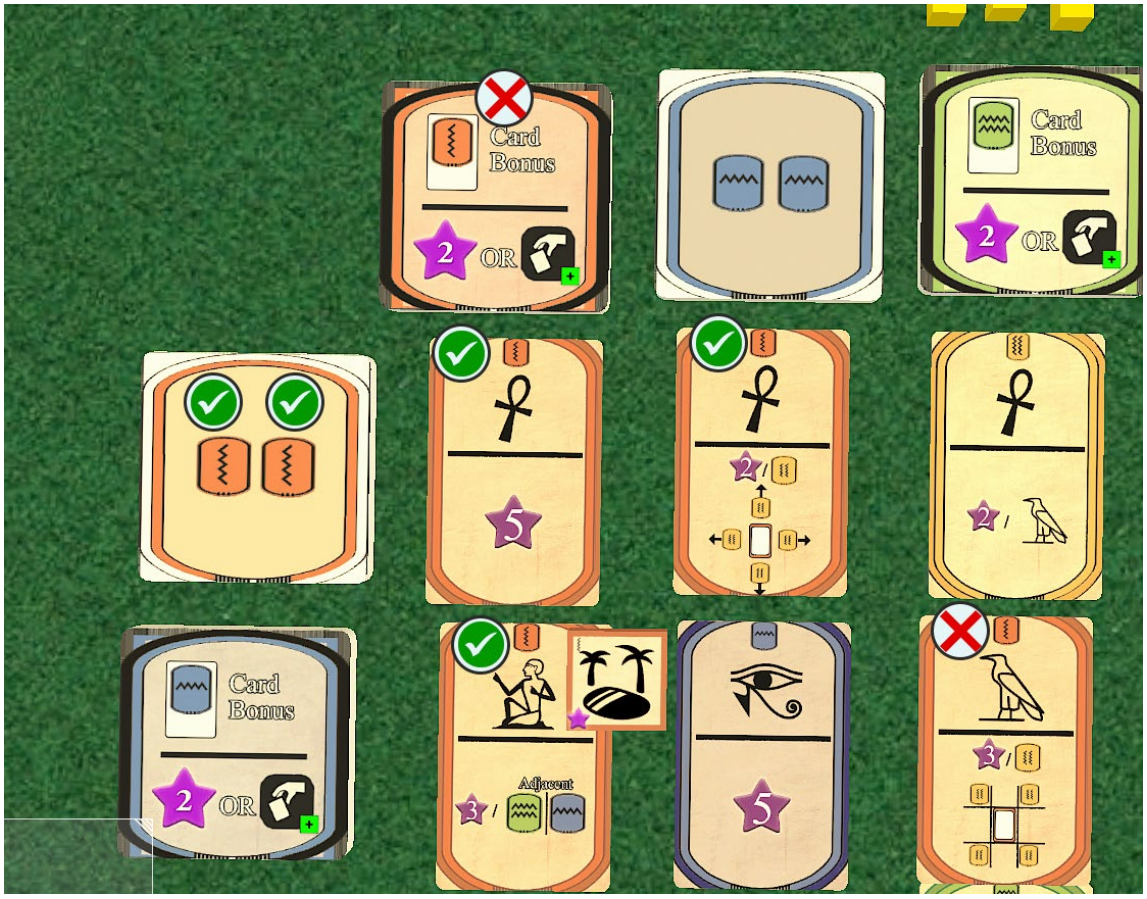


Move a card on your grid – this needs to move to an empty position.

Place an Oasis Token on that card matching the colour. – Each player can only have one of each coloured Oasis.



Oasis tokens get placed directly on a card. They will score points at game end based on the amount of matching coloured tags in this cluster where the Oasis is. A cluster is any number of directly adjacent (not diagonal) cards or remnants with the symbol located on them. Score 1 pointper matching tag.



In this example, the Oasis will score 5 points. The top Remnant does not have any tags on the black side. The matching coloured card in the bottom right is not in the cluster.

Maat



Swap 2 cards in your grid – tokens on the card stay on those cards.

Place a scale on one of the swapped cards



Scales will score 3 points at the end if the directly mirrored vertically card has a matching colour token on it.

Gods

These Gods allow players to manipulate remnants. These Gods are not recommended for a first game, but can be added in.

Remnant Tokens


Discard this token for the player to either move or flip a remnant.

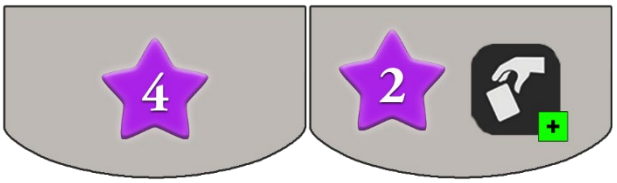
- Flipping a Remnant allows you to flip the side of a Remnant between Black and White.
- Moving a Remnant allows you to move a Remnant to any empty location around the grid (even below or to the right of the 4x4 grid of cards.

Seshat



Add an Improvement Token to a Remnant to change its match bonus – instead of a draw token or 2 points, it is replaced by this.

Gain a Remnant Token

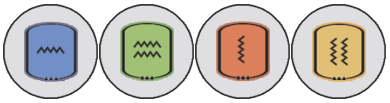


Thoth



Gain a Remnant Token

Add a colour token to the white side of a remnant (limit 1 per remnant).



These will add an additional colour tag you can score off.

Modules and Variation

From the first game, you may mix and match any of the following modules to increase the complexity.

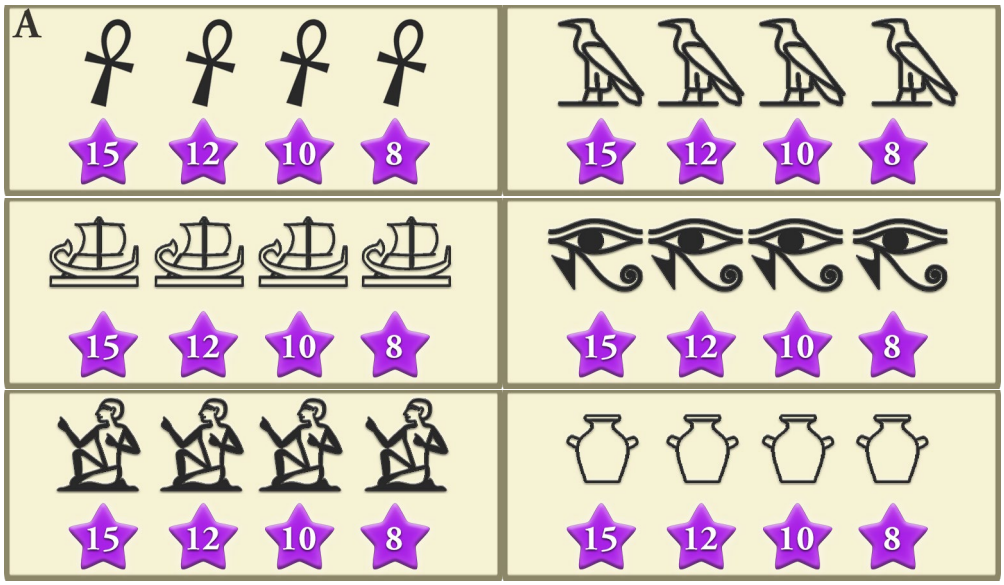
Module 1: The fourth God

Use the Remnant Gods 

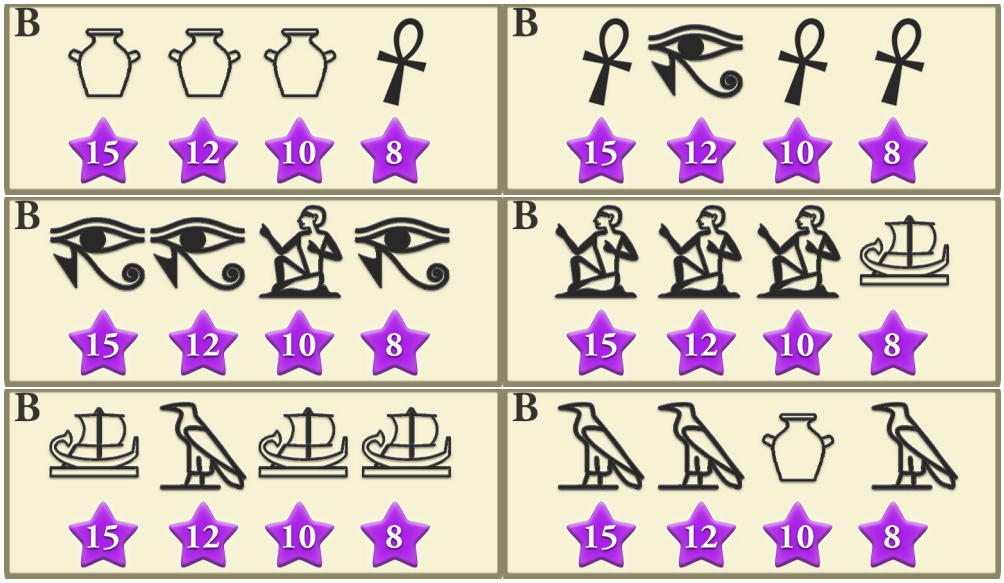
Module 2: Objectives

You can change between the A and B side of the objectives.

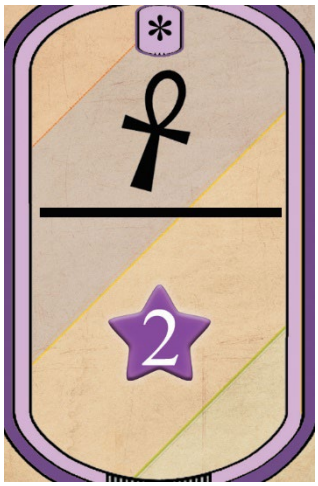
A



B

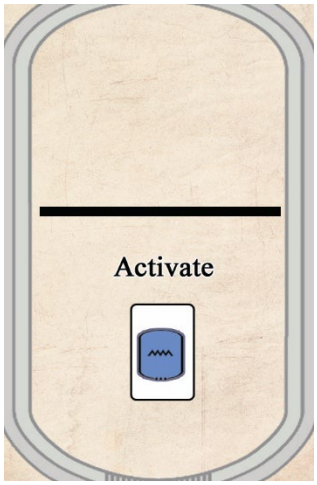


Module 3: Purple Cards



Add the purple cards to the deck. These give a wild purple token that can change colour each round and also once at game end.

Module 4: Activate Cards



These cards allow you to activate a different card in your grid with the matching tag on it.

These cards do not have a hieroglyph on them and can't have hieroglyph tokens placed on them. They also do not have a colour tag.

Module 5: Advanced Scribes

Instead of playing with the 5-point side of the scribes, players may play with one or all scribes with the advanced modular scoring. Like normal scribes, these will score at game end.



Solo Mode

In the solo game, players must verse the solobot and outscore them. Players play the same way as a multiplayer game. The actions of the solobot will depend on the solo deck that they will draw from.

Setup

Setup the game exactly the same as a multiplayer game for 2 players

Bot Setup

1: From the starter deck, give the bot 4 cards – 1 of each colour with 4 unique hieroglyphs.

2: Give the bot a colour and place their markers in their supply. Place one on the score track.

3: Get their solo deck of 8 cards and shuffle face down to form their deck. Discard 2 cards from their deck forming a discard pile.

Turn

Players will take their turns the same as a multiplayer game.

Bot Turn per Phase

More to come